Master Revision Guide

Compact full-syllabus revision: summaries, key facts and checklists for all 60 lectures.

Week 1: Foundations of Soft Skills and Communication

Lecture 1: Introduction to Soft Skills

Soft skills are an umbrella term for people, life and behavioural skills such as self-awareness, flexibility, persistence, friendliness and optimism. They complement hard (technical) skills, make people employable and are learned continuously. Communication is only one part of soft skills. The widening gap between academia and industry, and rising unemployment among qualified people, show why employers value them.

KEY FACTS

- Soft skills is an **umbrella term**; they are also called life skills, people skills and behavioural skills.
- Estimates of the number of soft skills vary (28, 60 or 10) because the skills overlap.
- Working definition: personality traits, social graces, facility with language, personal habits, friendliness and optimism.
- Behavioural skills named first: self-awareness, then flexibility, then persistence and perseverance.
- Soft skills are performance skills and a process of continuous learning.
- Hard skills are part of the college curriculum; soft skills are not taught as a college subject.

☐ I can state the working definition of soft skills.
☐ I can list three differences between hard and soft skills.
☐ I know why communication skills alone are not soft skills.
☐ I can quote Vivekananda’s mantra and explain its three parts.
☐ I remember the employability evidence (Census 2011, 23 lakh peon applicants, NASSCOM remark).

Lecture 2: Aspects of Soft Skills

Soft skills have several aspects: effective communication (listening, speaking, reading, writing), attitude, adaptability, teamwork, conflict management, leadership, time and space skills, mannerism and cultural sensitivity. Listening is the foundation; business writing aims to express, not impress. Teams, not individuals, are the performance unit, and constructive conflict helps. De Bono’s hats support creative problem solving.

KEY FACTS

- Latin *communicare* = to share.
- 60–75 per cent of one's time in any job is spent in listening.
- Four communication skills: listening, speaking, reading, writing; writing is the most challenging.
- Business writing: express, do not impress.
- Five negative Cs: criticizing, complaining, comparing, competing, contending.
- Green hat = generating ideas; white = objective; red = emotion; yellow = positive; blue = control.

☐ I can list the aspects of soft skills.
☐ I know the four communication skills and why listening comes first.
☐ I can match each Six Thinking Hat to its function.
☐ I remember Hume, Bidlake and the culture quotation.
☐ I can state the 60–75 per cent listening fact.

Lecture 3: Effective Communication Skills

Communication is a process in which a sender encodes an idea, sends it through a channel, the receiver decodes it, and feedback completes the cycle. A shared frame of reference, a suitable medium and environment, and a message that is clear, complete, concise, correct, courteous and candid improve effectiveness. Organisational communication may be internal (upward, downward, horizontal, diagonal, including the grapevine) or external.

KEY FACTS

- Bernard Shaw: the greatest problem in communication is the illusion that it has been accomplished.
- Communication is a process; feedback completes it.
- A common frame of reference is essential for success.
- Conciseness is the hallmark of communication.
- Grapevine = informal channel, often rumour-based and not always authentic; it may be used carefully.
- Internal flow: upward, downward, horizontal, vertical, diagonal.

☐ I can draw and explain the communication process.
☐ I can explain the Shaw quotation.
☐ I know the qualities of effective communication.
☐ I can distinguish internal, external and grapevine communication.
☐ I know the directions of internal communication.

Lecture 4: Classification of Communication

Communication may be oral or written and, by participants, intrapersonal, interpersonal, extra-personal, group or mass/media. It is also verbal, non-verbal or meta-communication, carried in print or electronic

media, and shaped by culture, ethics and law. Effective communicators avoid plagiarism, libel and slander and communicate ‘to bind, not to divide’.

KEY FACTS

- Interpersonal communication is also called dyadic communication.
- Intrapersonal: brain acts as receiver; soliloquy and aside are examples.
- Mass/media receivers are passive; media include newspapers and television.
- More than 6 lakh non-verbal cues exist.
- Meaning lies with the sender, not in words.
- Written criticism = libel; spoken = slander.

☐ I can list the five forms by number of participants.
☐ I can compare oral and written communication.
☐ I know what meta-communication means.
☐ I can distinguish libel, slander and plagiarism.
☐ I can give cross-cultural examples from the lecture.

Lecture 5: Personality Development

Personality (from *persona*, mask) is the inner set of qualities, attitudes, values and behaviours that make people distinct. Freud explained it through the id (pleasure), ego (reality) and superego (perfection). Adler, opposing Freud, stressed social interest, fictional finalism and striving for superiority, with the possibility of becoming a creative self.

KEY FACTS

- *Persona* = mask.
- Id: pleasure principle, true psychic reality, matrix of ego and superego.
- Ego: executive of the personality and organised portion of the id; reality principle.
- Superego: strives for perfection rather than pleasure; opposes both id and ego; moral guardian.
- Id relieves tension by reflex action and wish fulfilment.
- Freud’s book: *Interpretation of Dreams*.

☐ I can explain the origin of the word personality.
☐ I can describe id, ego and superego with their principles.
☐ I can state Adler’s key ideas.
☐ I can contrast Freud and Adler.
☐ I remember the quotations and the Thangavelu example.

Week 2: Positivity, Telephone and Non-verbal Communication

Lecture 6: Positive Thinking

Positive thinking is the belief that one can succeed; optimists create opportunities while pessimists see obstacles. Eric Berne’s four attitudes show why ‘I’m OK, you’re OK’ suits teamwork. The Johari Window

(Luft and Ingham, 1955) uses four areas – open, blind, hidden, unknown – to show how feedback and disclosure increase self-awareness. Positivism is built by believing in one's abilities, not imitating blindly and pursuing one's goals.

KEY FACTS

- Glass half empty = pessimist; half full = optimist.
- Peale wrote *The Power of Positive Thinking*.
- William James: we are only half awake.
- 'I'm OK, you're OK' = positive and co-operative; 'I'm OK, you're not OK' = imposing; 'I'm not OK, you're not OK' = introvert; 'I'm not OK, you're OK' = negative.
- Johari Window: Luft and Ingham, 1955; four areas: open, blind, hidden, unknown.
- Blind area = unknown to self but known by others.

☐ I can distinguish optimist and pessimist.
☐ I can state all four life positions and their labels.
☐ I can define the four Johari areas with known/unknown to self and others.
☐ I know who proposed each theory and when.
☐ I can list ways to develop positivism.

Lecture 7: Telephonic Communication Skills Part I

Telephonic communication bridges time and distance quickly and at low cost but lacks visual feedback, so clarity, courtesy, consideration and brevity are essential. A caller should plan an agenda, place his own call, identify himself, state the purpose and close politely; a receiver should answer within three rings, identify himself, respond positively and take accurate messages. Negative language is avoided.

KEY FACTS

- Four features: clarity, courtesy, consideration, brevity.
- Clarity is the first requirement of telephonic communication.
- Answer a call within three rings.
- Place your own call and plan an agenda.
- Identify yourself with name and affiliation when calling and when receiving.
- Avoid small talk and negative words such as 'No' or 'You have to'.

☐ I can list the four features of telephonic communication.
☐ I know the steps for making and receiving a call.
☐ I can rephrase negative sentences positively.
☐ I know the three-ring rule.
☐ I can describe how to take messages and transfer calls.

Lecture 8: Telephonic Communication Skills Part II

Voice mail replaces short memos, overcomes time zones and cuts paperwork but gives no immediate feedback. Mobile phone etiquette stresses low voice, silence in public places and no odd-hour calls. Teleconferencing connects dispersed people at short notice but is poor for negotiation, while video

conferencing adds visuals and has three types; users must manage equipment, speech and body language.

KEY FACTS

- Voice mail substitutes for short memos and phone calls and solves time-zone difficulties.
- Voice mail lacks immediate, specific feedback.
- Teleconferencing is ineffective for negotiations.
- Teleconferencing can be arranged at short notice and connects dispersed people.
- Three types of video conferencing (one-way, mixed, two-way).
- Speak in a low, modulated tone on cell phones; silent mode in meetings and worship places.

☐ I can state advantages and limits of voice mail.
☐ I know cell phone etiquette.
☐ I can contrast teleconferencing and video conferencing.
☐ I know the three types of video conferencing.
☐ I remember why teleconferencing fails for negotiation.

Lecture 9: Communicating Without Words

Non-verbal communication complements words and is spontaneous and unintentional. Birdwhistell put it at 65% and Mehrabian at 55% with 38% vocal. Its categories are kinesics, proxemics, chronemics, paralanguage, haptics and meta-communication. Kinesics covers appearance, face, eyes, movement, posture and gestures, all of which vary by culture and must be controlled to create a favourable impression.

KEY FACTS

- Birdwhistell: 35% verbal, 65% non-verbal.
- Mehrabian: 7% verbal, 38% vocal, rest non-verbal.
- More than 6 lakh non-verbal cues.
- Non-verbal communication is spontaneous and unintentional.
- Kinesics = body language; proxemics = space; chronemics = time; haptics = touch.
- Kinesics forms: appearance, facial expression, eye contact, posture, gesture, movement.

☐ I know both percentage splits.
☐ I can list the six types of non-verbal communication.
☐ I can list the forms of kinesics.
☐ I know hand-gesture meanings.
☐ I remember the cultural differences in eye contact.

Lecture 10: Paralanguage

Paralanguage covers voice quality, volume, rate, pitch, pronunciation and pauses. Speakers should speak at about 140–150 words per minute, vary pitch to avoid monotony, articulate each sound distinctly, follow Received Pronunciation, stress content words and use pauses and silence intentionally.

Voice faults such as throatiness, breathiness, nasalisation, harshness, muffling and hoarseness can be reduced by training, except hoarseness, which is medical.

KEY FACTS

- Ideal rate is about 140–150 words per minute.
- Pitch changes are called inflections; rises and falls in the voice are intonation.
- Voice faults: throatiness, breathiness, nasalisation, harshness, muffling, hoarseness.
- Hoarseness results from inflammation of the larynx; consult a speech therapist.
- Articles, prepositions, conjunctions, auxiliaries and personal pronouns do not take stress.
- Mark Twain on the rightly timed pause.

☐ I can list the features of voice.
☐ I know the voice faults and causes.
☐ I remember 140–150 wpm.
☐ I know which words take stress and which tones fall or rise.
☐ I can quote Mark Twain and Pythagoras.

Week 3: Space, Touch, Meta-communication and Listening

Lecture 11: Proxemics

Proxemics studies how space communicates. Four zones – intimate (to 18 in), personal (to 4 ft), social (4–12 ft), public (12–30 ft+) – are linked to relationship and status, and vary with culture. High-context cultures read non-verbal cues while low-context cultures rely on written words. Chronemics treats time as a commodity; punctuality and timing show professionalism, and ‘time talks and space speaks’.

KEY FACTS

- Four zones: intimate (up to 18 in), personal (18 in–4 ft), social (4–12 ft), public (12–30 ft+).
- Proxemics derives from proximity.
- Robert E. Hall: Time talks and space speaks.
- Low-context: North America, Germany, England, France, Italy, Scandinavia.
- High-context: Japan, China, Arab countries, Greece, Mexico, Spain.
- Bosses occupy larger or corner spaces.

☐ I know the four zones and distances.
☐ I can say who enters each zone.
☐ I can classify cultures by context.
☐ I can explain chronemics and cite Hall.
☐ I remember the Japanese car example.

Lecture 12: Haptics: The Language of Touch

Haptics is the language of touch and it varies by culture, gender and setting. Handshakes may express dominance, submission or equality; a dead-fish shake signals disinterest. Gestures with palms and

fingers also carry meaning. Because touch can be misread (Thailand's head taboo, Spanish seven-stroke handshakes), professionals should learn local norms, restrict touch when unsure and ensure verbal and non-verbal messages agree.

KEY FACTS

- Haptics comes from a Greek word meaning 'I touch'.
- Mulk Raj Anand wrote *Untouchable*; the protagonist is Bakha.
- In Spain a handshake should last at least seven strokes.
- In Thailand and Laos touching a child's head is rude because the head is sacred.
- Hongi is the New Zealand nose-touching greeting.
- Three handshake types: dominant, submissive and equal; also dead fish and glove.

☐ I know the origin of haptics.
☐ I can describe each handshake type.
☐ I recall cultural examples (Thailand, Spain, NZ, India, Japan).
☐ I know Anand's *Untouchable* and Bakha.
☐ I can explain verbal–non-verbal conflict.

Lecture 13: Meta-communication

Meta-communication is communication beyond words: choice of words, tone, positioning, hesitation and silence. Silence and pauses relieve monotony, give time to think, build rapport and add emphasis, while non-words (ah, um, I mean) harm clarity and show poor preparation. Speakers should provide silence deliberately, keep it short and read others' silences in context and culture.

KEY FACTS

- Meta means beyond.
- Meta-communication may be unintentional.
- 'Leave him, not kill him' example shows the effect of word positioning.
- Silence can hide meaning or show disagreement.
- Non-words include ah, um, 'I mean', O.K.
- Adrienne Rich: lying is done with words and also with silence.

☐ I can define meta-communication.
☐ I can show how word positioning changes meaning.
☐ I can list advantages of silence.
☐ I know why non-words harm a speech.
☐ I can distinguish pause and silence.

Lecture 14: Listening Skills

Listening is a conscious mental skill, unlike hearing. It passes through hearing, filtering, interpreting, responding and remembering. Perceptive listening, as defined by Ernest D. Nathan, needs a sincere desire to understand. Listening brings knowledge, relationships, better performance and vocabulary, but prejudging, ambiguity, bias, rigidity and premature evaluation block it.

KEY FACTS

- Listening process: hearing, filtering, interpreting, responding, remembering.
- 60–75% of time is spent in listening.
- Hearing is physiological; listening is mental.
- Ernest D. Nathan defined perceptive listening.
- Barriers: prejudging, ambiguity, bias, rigidity, premature evaluation.
- Listening builds knowledge, relationships and vocabulary.

☐ I can distinguish hearing and listening.
☐ I can list the five stages in order.
☐ I can define perceptive listening.
☐ I know the advantages and barriers.
☐ I remember 60–75% and SLANT.

Lecture 15: Types of Listening

Listening may be combative, attentive or reflective, with reflective listening the most valuable. In organisations content, empathetic, appreciative and analytical listening serve different purposes. Prejudice, noise, ego, preoccupation and language hamper listening, whereas an open mind, concentration, note-taking, patience and attention to non-verbal cues improve it.

KEY FACTS

- Three basic types: combative, attentive, reflective.
- Reflective listening is the most important.
- Types by purpose: content, empathetic, appreciative, analytical.
- External factors: noise, venue, time, culture.
- Internal factors: state of mind, ego, language, perception.
- Do not interrupt, whisper or hold parallel talks in meetings.

☐ I know the three basic types.
☐ I can match the four purpose-based types to situations.
☐ I can list external and internal barriers.
☐ I know tips and the Hemingway quote.
☐ I understand prejudiced listening.

Week 4: Negotiation, Culture and Organisational Communication

Lecture 16: Negotiation Skills I

Negotiation turns conflict into agreement through argument and persuasion. Formal negotiations are pre-announced with an agenda; informal ones are casual. Place, time, atmosphere, personal relations and fear affect results. A negotiator needs confidence, dignity, flexibility, honesty and competence,

must prepare facts and limits, secure a BATNA, avoid WATNA and seek a ZOPA that yields a win-win outcome.

KEY FACTS

- Negotiation arises from conflict and needs two parties.
- Formal negotiation announces date, venue, time and agenda; three persons involved.
- Informal negotiation is not pre-announced.
- Negotiation works by persuasion, not authority.
- BATNA, WATNA, ZOPA acronyms.
- Qualities: confidence, appearance, outlook, honesty, competence, flexibility.

☐ I can define negotiation.
☐ I can compare formal and informal negotiation.
☐ I can list factors and qualities.
☐ I can expand BATNA, WATNA, ZOPA.
☐ I remember Kennedy’s fear quote.

Lecture 17: Negotiation Skills II

Negotiation strategy depends on persuasion: style, you-attitude, body language and summarising. It runs through preparation, interaction and implementation. The purple style, blending cooperation and competition, is preferred, supported by collaboration, accommodation, compromise, control and emotional avoidance. Negotiators keep some points in reserve, record agreements, acknowledge cooperation and accept that outcomes can be win-win, win-lose or lose-win.

KEY FACTS

- Three phases: preparation, interaction, implementation.
- Red = competitive; blue = cooperative; purple = mix.
- You-attitude means telling the sunny side.
- Tim Hindle: almost impossible to over-prepare.
- Agree and write down the points; decide roles.
- No negotiation gives a total win to only one party.

☐ I know the three phases.
☐ I can contrast red, blue and purple.
☐ I can list approaches and dos and don’ts.
☐ I understand you-attitude.
☐ I remember outcome types.

Lecture 18: Culture as Communication

Culture is the learnt set of traits, values and behaviours of a group and strongly shapes communication. Globalisation brings cultural contact and, sometimes, cultural shock. Cultures differ in context, individualism, formality, communication style and time orientation; low-context Americans and Germans

are direct and word-based, while high-context Arabs, Japanese and Asians stress relationship, silence and non-verbal cues. Respect, deference and learning are the keys to cross-cultural success.

KEY FACTS

- Culture is learnt and dynamic.
- GATT and NAFTA promote trade across cultures.
- Dimensions: context, individualism, formality, communication style, time orientation.
- Americans: hamburger style; low context; time is money.
- Mexicans prefer courtesies before business.
- Arabs consider contracts insulting (high context).

☐ I can define culture.
☐ I know the five dimensions.
☐ I can contrast American, Japanese, Arab and Mexican styles.
☐ I can explain cultural shock.
☐ I remember translation blunders.

Lecture 19: Communicating across Cultures

Communication across cultures requires understanding that culture is a shared code. Low-context cultures trust words and contracts, while high-context cultures read silence, context and relationships. Differences in gestures, numbers, gifts, space, colour and ways of saying no cause misunderstanding. Avoid ethnocentrism and stereotypes; practise tolerance, empathy and adaptation, moving towards ethno-relativism.

KEY FACTS

- Low context: North America, Scandinavia, France, Germany.
- High context: Japan, China, Arab countries.
- Number 8 is lucky; 4 sounds like death in Hong Kong/China.
- Maneki neko is the Japanese beckoning cat.
- North Americans keep about 5 feet of space.
- Sicily raises the chin to say no; Bulgaria nods for no.

☐ I can quote Smith’s definition.
☐ I can compare low and high context.
☐ I know the ways of saying no.
☐ I can explain ethnocentrism and ethno-relativism.
☐ I remember gift and number examples.

Lecture 20: Organizational Communication

Organisational communication carries ideas through formal and informal channels so that goals are achieved. Its functions include forecasting, organising, instructing, coordinating and controlling; managers play interpersonal, informational and decisional roles. Understanding Maslow’s needs and

McGregor's styles helps leaders persuade rather than only control. Statutory and crisis communication, line–staff coordination and a careful use of the grapevine complete the picture.

KEY FACTS

- Scott's definition emphasises feedback and action.
- Functions: forecasting, organising, instructing, coordinating, controlling.
- Roles: interpersonal, informational, decisional.
- Maslow's hierarchy applies to employees.
- McGregor: traditional versus modern.
- Flows: vertical, horizontal, crosswise, spiral.

☐ I can define organisation and Scott's definition.
☐ I know the functions and roles.
☐ I can link Maslow and McGregor to employees.
☐ I know the flow types and channels.
☐ I can explain statutory and crisis communication.

Week 5: Communication Breakdown and Business Writing

Lecture 21: Communication Breakdown Part I

Communication breakdown occurs when something blocks the flow of a message. Barriers arise at the source (poor word choice, uncertain content, background, inference, perception, rigid thinking, frozen evaluation, allness), between people (vocabulary, emotion, distraction, poor listening, selectivity, noise, imbalance of verbal and non-verbal cues, semantic and cultural gaps) and in organisations. Awareness, feedback and careful choice of words reduce them.

KEY FACTS

- A. G. Gardiner's 'On Saying Please'.
- Three types: at the source, between people, in the organisation.
- Homophily means a common frame of reference.
- Allness uses words like all and every.
- SOS in a prescription means 'if required'.
- Mark Twain's lightning and lightning bug.

☐ I know three types of breakdown.
☐ I can list source barriers.
☐ I can list interpersonal barriers.
☐ I remember Gardiner and Twain.
☐ I can give semantic gap examples.

Lecture 22: Communication Breakdown Part II

Organisational barriers include tall hierarchies, fear of superiors, negative attitudes, mistrust, subgroups, many transfer stations, wrong media, information overload, jargon, physical distractions and unethical practices such as misquoting. They are overcome by empathy, careful words, active listening, audience-centred messages, an open climate, fewer levels, suitable media and prompt feedback.

KEY FACTS

- The message sent is not always the message received.
- Too many transfer stations distort messages.
- Media richness: choose the channel suited to the receiver.
- Reduce levels and encourage direct communication.
- Take immediate feedback.
- Whitman: what I assume you shall assume.

☐ I can list organisational barriers.
☐ I understand transfer stations.
☐ I can list remedies.
☐ I remember the passing-away story.
☐ I can quote Whitman.

Lecture 23: Advanced Writing Skills

Advanced writing is concept-based, researched, drafted, revised and reader-centred. It should be direct, simple and short-sentenced, planned with an outline. Informative writing reports facts; persuasive writing argues. Choose among nine patterns – direct, indirect, order of importance, chronology, problem–solution, causal, spatial, structural, topical – and put bad news in the indirect plan with a positive close.

KEY FACTS

- Bacon: writing maketh an exact man.
- Stages: conceptualise, research, draft, revise.
- Ask why and for whom.
- Nine patterns: direct, indirect, order of importance, chronology, problem–solution, causal, spatial, structural, topical.
- Bad news goes in the indirect plan with a positive ending.
- Short sentences of 6–8 words are simple.

☐ I can recall Bacon and Pope.
☐ I know the stages of writing.
☐ I can distinguish informative and persuasive writing.
☐ I can list the nine patterns.
☐ I can rewrite sentences with the verb first.

Lecture 24: Principles of Business Writing

Good business writing follows the 5 Cs. Express rather than impress: use plain, familiar words, cut redundant phrases and avoid foggy sentences. Show courtesy and consideration by taking the reader's viewpoint, soften negatives, put bad news in the middle and end with hope, and keep cordiality so that relationships and business continue.

KEY FACTS

- 5 Cs: clarity, courtesy, consideration, conciseness, cordiality.
- Goal of business writing: to express, not to impress.
- Eliot: do not use big words; do not say infinitely for very.
- Put negative news in the middle and end positively.
- Brevity is the soul of wit.
- Revision is the last task in writing.

☐ I can list the 5 Cs.
☐ I know the concise replacements.
☐ I can rewrite rude sentences politely.
☐ I remember Eliot and Wilde.
☐ I know express vs impress.

Lecture 25: Types of Business Writing Part I

Business writing includes letters, reports, memos, letter reports, circulars, e-mails, proposals and research papers. A memo is a short, informal intra-office document with letterhead, To/From (designation), reference and date, subject line and body but no salutation or close. A letter report is a longer, letter-format report that may go outside; a circular informs larger audiences and has four types.

KEY FACTS

- Memo = inter-office memorandum.
- A memo has no salutation or complimentary close.
- From line shows designation.
- Reference number and date on the right.
- cc line at the end left.
- Letter report may have 2–3 pages and enclosures.

☐ I can list types of business writing.
☐ I know memo format.
☐ I can compare memo, letter report and circular.
☐ I know four circular types.
☐ I know memo purposes.

Week 6: Business Writing and Business Letters

Lecture 26: Types of Business Writing Part II

A meeting is documented through a notice (issued days ahead with date, time, venue and agenda), an agenda (numbered items beginning with confirmation of previous minutes and ending with any other matter) and minutes (a signed, past-tense, sequential record). E-mails need brevity, courtesy and care with cc, capitals and attachments. Research papers require a specific title, literature review, outline, statement of purpose, revision and references.

KEY FACTS

- Notice is pre-information of a meeting.
- First agenda item: confirmation of previous minutes.
- Last agenda item: any other matter with the permission of the chair.
- Minutes are written in the past tense by the secretary.
- Item numbering such as 5.1 means meeting 5, item 1.
- Capitals in e-mail are like shouting.

☐ I can draft a notice.
☐ I know agenda rules.
☐ I can write minutes in the right tense.
☐ I know e-mail etiquette.
☐ I know research paper steps.

Lecture 27: Business Letters

Business letters keep organisations and customers in touch, serve as records and reveal the writer's skill. They are formal, neutral and direct, unlike personal letters. The standard structure has ten parts – letterhead, date, reference, inside address, subject, salutation, body, complimentary close, signature and enclosures – and requires accuracy, courtesy and prompt replies.

KEY FACTS

- A business letter has at least ten parts.
- Use 'Dear Sir/Madam'.
- Yours faithfully / sincerely; no apostrophe after 'Yours'.
- Reference includes 'our reference' and 'your reference'.
- Body usually has three paragraphs.
- Identification marks: dictator's and typist's initials.

☐ I can list the ten parts.
☐ I know the date and reference conventions.
☐ I know the correct complimentary close.
☐ I can explain business vs personal letters.
☐ I recall Chesterfield.

Lecture 28: Business Letters: Format & Style

Business letters are laid out in four formats – full block (all left), modified block (date, close and signature right of centre), semi-block (indented paragraphs) and simplified (no salutation or close, with subject and attention line). Whatever the format, style must be reader-friendly: thank, be specific and brief, avoid blame and negatives, use ‘we’ for the organisation and keep a positive, cordial tone.

KEY FACTS

- Four formats: full block, modified block, semi-block, simplified.
- Full block: all on the left margin.
- Open punctuation: none in address, salutation and close.
- Semi-block: indented paragraphs.
- Simplified: no salutation or close; attention line.
- When gender unknown: Dear + first name.

☐ I know the four formats.
☐ I know open punctuation.
☐ I can rewrite negatives positively.
☐ I know I vs we.
☐ I know when to use the simplified format.

Lecture 29: Types of Business Letters Part I

Business letters include sales, enquiry, reply, order, credit, refusal, collection, claim, adjustment and recognition letters. Sales letters follow AIDA and avoid exaggeration and negatives. Enquiries state the main idea first; replies lead with good news and answer all queries; order letters are specific and state payment; credit requests need references; refusals thank, explain and keep hope. Sir Ernest Gowers’ advice guides tone.

KEY FACTS

- AIDA = Attention, Interest, Desire, Action.
- Three As of planning: analysis, anticipation, adaptation.
- Gowers: if he is rude, be specially courteous.
- Enquiry: main idea first; polite command ends with a period.
- Reply: good news first, avoid dull openings.
- Order letter: specific, vertical list, payment procedure.

☐ I can expand AIDA.
☐ I know Gowers’ advice.
☐ I can write enquiry and reply letters.
☐ I know order and credit letter rules.
☐ I can write a polite refusal.

Lecture 30: Types of Business Letters Part II

Collection letters grow firmer across a series but keep goodwill. Claim letters state the problem and desired remedy politely with documents; adjustment letters open with the good news in active voice, explain, show empathy, avoid blame and negative words and thank the customer. Recommendation letters must be honest, specific and confidential. Simplicity and cordiality underlie all letters.

KEY FACTS

- Collection letters form a series with increasing firmness.
- Open claim letters with the problem or action wanted.
- Do not blame; include documents.
- Adjustment letters open with good news in active voice.
- Address the claimant by name.
- Avoid trouble, fault, regret, misunderstanding and unrealistic promises.

☐ I know the tone progression in collection letters.
☐ I can write a claim letter.
☐ I can write an adjustment letter.
☐ I know recommendation letter rules.
☐ I can list words to avoid.

Week 7: Report Writing

Lecture 31: Report Writing

A report (from Latin *reportare*) is a formal, factual, systematic communication prepared on demand for a specific audience and purpose. It describes procedure and data, draws conclusions and may recommend action. Reports update, evaluate, correct, inform and create awareness. Unlike literary writing, reports are objective, structured, plain and audience-specific.

KEY FACTS

- Report derives from Latin reportare (re + portare).
- A report is a formal communication for a specific purpose.
- Reports are need-based, not self-initiated.
- A report is a professional’s only tangible product.
- Reports contain data, procedure, conclusions and recommendations.
- Illustrations include charts, graphs, pie charts and tables.

☐ I know the etymology and definition.
☐ I can list the attributes.
☐ I can list the objectives.
☐ I can differentiate report from literary writing.
☐ I recall ‘tangible product’.

Lecture 32: Types of Reports

Reports vary by length (short or long), form (written or oral), subject (management or technical), frequency (routine or special) and function (informative or analytical). Short reports are informal; technical reports are formal and documented and must rest on authentic data. Informative reports present facts; analytical reports interpret and may recommend. Routine reports are periodic and proforma-based, management reports are short and non-technical, and special reports arise in critical situations. A report should cover everything necessary, but nothing more.

KEY FACTS

- Reports are classified by length, form, subject, frequency and function.
- Letter and memo reports are short reports.
- Do not recommend unless asked; conclusion is fine.
- Technical report needs authentic data and sources.
- Technical reports are informative or analytical.
- Analytical reports can run 30–35 pages.

☐ I can classify reports by five bases.
☐ I know short vs technical.
☐ I know informative vs analytical.
☐ I can describe routine, management and special reports.
☐ I recall the bathing-suit quote.

Lecture 33: Strategies for Report Writing Part I

Preparing a report starts with the purpose and scope defined in the terms of reference, then analysis of the audience and its attitude, selection of data-collection methods, organisation of material and an outline. Data come from primary sources (personal observation, investigation) and secondary sources (library, Internet, internal records). Observation gives first-hand data but is biased, slow and cannot interpret behaviour; telephonic interviews reach many people cheaply but lack depth and non-verbal cues.

KEY FACTS

- Preparation: purpose and scope, audience, data method, organisation, outline.
- TOR = terms of reference.
- Know the attitude of readers.
- Primary sources: observation and investigation.
- Secondary sources: library, Internet, internal records.
- Observation reports behaviour but cannot interpret it.

☐ I know the five preparation steps.
☐ I can define TOR.
☐ I can classify data sources.
☐ I know observation limits.
☐ I know telephone interview pros and cons.

Lecture 34: Strategies for Report Writing Part II

Personal interviews give reliable, verifiable, first-hand data with non-verbal cues and interviewer control but are costly; the interviewer should plan, listen, avoid arguments and embarrassing questions. Questionnaires reach many respondents cheaply and anonymously but risk low and unrepresentative responses. A good questionnaire is short, simple, logical, error-free, uses closed, rating, open-ended and multiple-choice questions, avoids leading questions, places tricky ones in the middle and carries a covering letter. Ruskin: a clearly asked question is two-thirds answered.

KEY FACTS

- Personal interview = conversation with a purpose.
- Non-verbal cues are available in personal interviews.
- Do not argue in an interview; listen more.
- Seek appointments in advance.
- Questionnaires save time and travel and allow anonymity.
- Types: closed, rating, open-ended, multiple choice.

☐ I can define personal interview and questionnaire.
☐ I know tips for interviewing.
☐ I can list question types.
☐ I know questionnaire guidelines.
☐ I recall Freud and Ruskin.

Lecture 35: Evaluation and Organization of Data

Collected data must be evaluated through sampling (probability: random, systematic, stratified; non-probability: convenience, judgment), noted carefully with quotation marks, abbreviations and note cards, and organised into an outline. The outline follows the principles of indenting, numbering (decimal, up to three levels), coordination, subordination, parallel grammatical construction and logical ordering, uses phrases rather than sentences and serves as a tentative guide; a good outline means half the report is done.

KEY FACTS

- Evaluate data by sampling.
- Probability sampling: random, systematic, stratified.
- Systematic example: every ninth record.
- Non-probability: convenience, judgment.
- Quote with quotation marks.
- Decimal numbering preferred.

☐ I know sampling types.
☐ I can make notes properly.
☐ I can list outline principles.
☐ I can draft a decimal outline.
☐ I know parallelism.

Week 8: Report Structure, Style and Group Communication

Lecture 36: Structure of Reports: Part-I

A technical report has front matter, main body and back matter. The front matter contains the cover, frontispiece, title page, copyright notice, forwarding letter, preface, acknowledgement, table of contents, list of illustrations and abstract or summary. The cover carries the report number, title, writer, recipient, organisation and date; the title page adds the subtitle and 'approved by'. The preface is by the author, the foreword by an expert. The table of contents carries page numbers. Abstracts and summaries use neutral, concise language.

KEY FACTS

- Report has three parts: front matter, main body, back matter.
- Front matter items in order: cover, frontispiece, title page, copyright, forwarding letter, preface, acknowledgement, contents, illustrations, abstract.
- 'Approved by' goes at lower left of the title page.
- Copyright notice on the back of the title page.
- Forwarding letter is also called letter of transmittal.
- Preface by author; foreword by expert.

☐ I can name the three parts.
☐ I can list front matter in order.
☐ I know cover and title page contents.
☐ I can differentiate preface and foreword.
☐ I know abstract vs summary.

Lecture 37: Structure of Reports: Part-II

The main body has introduction (background, authorisation, scope, limitations, methods, definitions, preview), discussion (analysis and interpretation), conclusion (based on analysis, no new data) and recommendation (only if asked and feasible). The back matter holds appendices, list of references, bibliography, glossary and index. A list of references contains only cited works; a bibliography lists all consulted works. APA and MLA differ in the position of the year.

KEY FACTS

- Main body: introduction, discussion, conclusion, recommendation.
- Introduction gives background, authorisation, scope, limitations, methods, definitions and preview.
- Conclusion contains no new information.
- Recommend only when asked and keep it feasible.
- Appendices hold supporting material labelled A, B, C.
- List of references = cited works; bibliography = consulted works.

☐ I know the four parts of the main body.
☐ I can list introduction contents.

☐ I know conclusion and recommendation rules.
☐ I can list back matter items.
☐ I can differentiate bibliography and references.

Lecture 38: Report Style: Part I

Report language should be simple, specific and familiar so that readers of different backgrounds can act on it. Avoid unusual words, clichés, jargon, foreign phrases, redundancy, circumlocution, phrasal verbs, double modifiers, misplaced modifiers and unfamiliar abbreviations. Replace difficult terms with synonyms, give exact figures and revise. As Hawthorne notes, words become powerful in the hands of one who knows how to combine them.

KEY FACTS

- Report language must be simple, specific and familiar.
- Cliché = overused expression.
- Jargon = technical language unknown to the reader.
- Redundancy = unnecessary repetition.
- Circumlocution = roundabout expression.
- Use one modifier, not two.

☐ I can define cliché, jargon, redundancy, circumlocution.
☐ I can simplify difficult words.
☐ I can correct misplaced modifiers.
☐ I know abbreviation rules.
☐ I recall Hawthorne’s quote.

Lecture 39: Report Style: Part II

Good report style mixes active and passive voice (passive neutralises blame), keeps subject and verb close, uses emphatic word order, parallel construction and a mix of short and long sentences, and splits breathless sentences. Noun clusters should be replaced by verbs. Paragraphs need unity, coherence, order and a topic sentence, linked by transitions. Readability can be measured by Gunning’s fog index (0.4 × (average sentence length + % difficult words)); a score below 12 is readable. Style should be unobtrusive, like a windowpane (Orwell).

KEY FACTS

- Vary voice, sentence length and word order.
- Passive neutralises allegations.
- Subject then verb, close together.
- Positive points come first in comparisons.
- Split breathless sentences.
- Replace noun clusters with verbs.

☐ I know when to use active and passive.
☐ I can revise noun clusters.

☐ I can structure a paragraph.
☐ I can list transitions.
☐ I can calculate the fog index.

Lecture 40: Group Communication

A group is a collection of people cooperating for a common goal in a set time; a team is a subdivision with collective accountability. Groups solve problems, investigate opportunities, write reports, give presentations and develop products. They may be formal, informal or virtual. Advantages are more information, diversity, acceptance, performance and belonging; disadvantages include ego clashes, ignoring individuals, groupthink and hidden agendas. Group dynamics: cooperation, loyalty, cohesiveness. Tuckman's stages: forming, storming, norming, performing, adjourning. Roles are self-oriented, maintenance and task-facilitating.

KEY FACTS

- Tuckman stages: forming, storming, norming, performing, adjourning.
- Team = collective accountability.
- Tasks: solve problems, investigate opportunities, write reports, present, develop products.
- Types of groups: formal, informal, virtual.
- Group dynamics: cooperation, loyalty, cohesiveness.
- Roles: self-oriented, maintenance, task-facilitating.

☐ I can define group and team.
☐ I know group tasks and types.
☐ I can list advantages and disadvantages.
☐ I know the five Tuckman stages.
☐ I know the three roles.

Week 9: Leadership, Discussion, Meetings and Ethics

Lecture 41: Leadership Skills

A leader emerges from the group and shows initiative, integrity, knowledge and concern. Styles are autocratic, democratic, laissez-faire, transactional and transformational. Leader behaviour has two dimensions, initiating structure and consideration, and Fiedler's model links effectiveness to the fit between a fixed task or relationship style and the situation. Charismatic and visionary leaders inspire change; leadership differs across cultures. Trust, built on integrity, competence, consistency, loyalty and openness, is the hallmark. Bennis: leadership is the capacity to translate vision into reality.

KEY FACTS

- A leader emerges from the group.
- Five styles: autocratic, democratic, laissez-faire, transactional, transformational.
- Initiating structure and consideration are two dimensions.
- Fiedler: leadership style fixed; task or relationship oriented.
- Charismatic leaders have vision and conviction.
- Transformational leader inspires beyond self-interest.

☐ I can list leader traits.
☐ I know five styles.
☐ I know Fiedler's model.
☐ I can describe charismatic and visionary leaders.
☐ I can list elements of trust.

Lecture 42: Group Discussion: Part I

Group discussion is a formal, unstructured, cooperative, dialogic exchange used to shortlist candidates. Unlike a structured, competitive debate with fixed sides, GD allows flexible stances and uses simple, factual, polite language. Held in a circle or semi-circle with 7–10 participants for 15–25 minutes, it may be a topic GD or case GD. Evaluators look for awareness, reasoning, behaviour, initiative, motivation, assertiveness, listening and leadership; participants have individual and group responsibilities. Leaders may be drivers, amiable, democrats or bulldozers.

KEY FACTS

- GD is formal, face-to-face, unstructured and cooperative.
- Debate is structured with motion for/against.
- GD seating: circular or semi-circular.
- 7–10 participants; 15–25 minutes.
- Two types: topic GD and case GD.
- No designated leader in GD.

☐ I can define GD.
☐ I can differentiate debate and GD.
☐ I know topic vs case GD.
☐ I know the qualities evaluated.
☐ I know leader types.

Lecture 43: Group Discussion: Part II

In a GD the leader emerges from the group; he is communicative, liberal, eager, democratic, assertive, erudite and rational, saves the group from conflict, summarises and encourages silent members. Panelists observe participation, tone, gestures and fairness. Prepare by sitting comfortably, listening to the topic, organising thoughts, speaking early but politely, sharing time, maintaining eye contact and encouraging others. Avoid dominating, acting as chairman, extreme stands, arguments, whispering,

looking at the panelist, over-speed and digressions. Topics may be factual, abstract, fictional or controversial; a solid, logical stand and decorum are essential.

KEY FACTS

- The GD leader is emergent.
- Silent members are a liability to the group.
- Panelists observe both verbal and non-verbal behaviour.
- Listen to the topic carefully; keywords matter.
- Organise thoughts; use complete sentences.
- Never take the role of a chairman.

☐ I know the emergent leader’s traits.
☐ I know what panelists observe.
☐ I can list GD dos.
☐ I can list GD don’ts.
☐ I know GD topic types.

Lecture 44: Meeting Management

Meetings are organised gatherings to share information, train, solve problems, plan, demonstrate products and above all make decisions. They fail through poor planning and leadership. Before calling a meeting ask why, who, when, where and what; check calendars, venue and facilities and circulate the agenda. During the meeting start on time, follow the agenda, encourage participation, record official minutes; participants should follow etiquette. Close by summarising, assigning responsibilities and deadlines and promising to circulate minutes.

KEY FACTS

- Meeting = organised gathering for a purpose.
- Overall function of every meeting: decision making.
- Plan with why, who, when, where, what.
- Agenda is circulated in advance.
- Start on time; follow agenda.
- Minutes should not record unpleasant incidents.

☐ I can list meeting functions.
☐ I know why meetings fail.
☐ I can plan using wh-questions.
☐ I know conduct and etiquette.
☐ I know closing steps.

Lecture 45: Adaptability and Work Ethics

Adaptability is the ability to change with new circumstances; it helps employees learn and strengthens the organisation. Ethics is the sense of right and wrong; work ethics rests on hard work, diligence, reliability and loyalty. Employer–employee relations are bound by trust and law; Kant argues employees

are ends, not merely means. Employees have rights – freedom from discrimination, privacy, due process, participation, safe conditions, fair wages and speech – and duties. Avoid plagiarism, misuse of resources, misquoting, credit stealing and data misrepresentation; follow the code of conduct and act as the organisation's ambassador.

KEY FACTS

- Adaptability = ability to change to new circumstances.
- Ethics = sense of right and wrong.
- Work ethic is based on hard work and diligence.
- Kant: treat employees as ends, not only means.
- Rights come with duties.
- Loyalty to organisation outweighs loyalty to friends in confidentiality.

☐ I can define adaptability and ethics.
☐ I know employer–employee obligations.
☐ I can list employee rights.
☐ I can list unethical practices.
☐ I recall Kant.

Week 10: Speaking, Presentations and Nervousness

Lecture 46: Advanced Speaking Skills

Speaking is a skill that complements writing: it is fast, face to face, emotive and spontaneous, builds rapport and credibility, and gives immediate feedback. It is needed in conversation, meetings, negotiations, GDs, debates, speeches, presentations and interviews. Effective speaking rests on four components – voice (trainable), vocabulary (familiar, context-appropriate), audience (know and adapt) and style (enthusiasm, audibility, variety). Franklin: leaving unsaid the wrong thing at the tempting moment is harder than saying the right thing.

KEY FACTS

- LSRW: this lecture is on speaking.
- Four components: voice, vocabulary, audience, style.
- Voice can be trained; the quality itself is a gift.
- Use familiar words.
- Know your audience; imagine a mixed audience if unknown.
- Speakers win or lose at the start.

☐ I can explain why speaking is a skill.
☐ I know speaking situations.
☐ I can list advantages over writing.
☐ I can name four components.
☐ I recall Franklin.

Lecture 47: Oral Presentations, Speeches, and Debates

Speaking serves to inform, persuade or entertain. An oral presentation is a planned, factual talk to a small defined audience, using visual aids and ending with a question–answer session that leads to decisions; occasions include budgets, briefings, training and product launches. A speech is a formal oral address to a larger audience for an occasion, usually without visual aids. A debate develops argumentative ability and critical thinking and requires research, rehearsal, careful listening, effective rebuttal and courtesy.

KEY FACTS

- Speaking aims to inform, persuade or entertain.
- Oral presentations suit small defined groups and use visual aids.
- Prepare for the Q&A by anticipating questions.
- Briefings: press, vendors, senior executives.
- Speeches normally lack visual aids.
- Debate develops argumentative ability and critical thinking.

☐ I can distinguish presentation, speech, debate.
☐ I know occasions for presentations.
☐ I can prepare for the Q&A.
☐ I know debate preparation steps.
☐ I recall Roosevelt’s quote.

Lecture 48: Combating Nervousness

Nervousness is a natural, universal psychological and physiological response – dry throat, trembling, quivering voice, rapid heartbeat – caused by concern for one’s image and unfamiliarity. It is useful because adrenaline gives extra energy (William James). Control it through thorough preparation, knowing the audience, starting with familiar topics, rehearsing and recording yourself, checking the venue, treating the audience as friends, pausing and breathing before speaking, speaking slowly, and reviewing if you forget. Fear is in the mind: bear it, not fear it.

KEY FACTS

- Nervousness is natural and universal.
- It is energising because of adrenaline.
- 80 per cent prefer death to public speaking (survey cited).
- William James: survival devices.
- Preparation is the best antidote.
- Begin with familiar topics.

☐ I know the symptoms.
☐ I know nervousness is natural.
☐ I can list causes and remedies.
☐ I know stress busters.
☐ I recall James, Sartre, Carnegie.

Lecture 49: Patterns and Methods of Presentation

Presentations are built on the 5 Ps and go through pre-, during and post-presentation stages. They may follow a chronological, causal, problem–solution, spatial or topical pattern. Delivery methods are reading from manuscript (accurate but lifeless), memorised (fresh but risky), impromptu (unprepared, brief, relies on experience) and extemporaneous (flexible, conversational, with outline and notes). Beginners should avoid reading and memorising; speaking extemporaneously with an outline is most effective.

KEY FACTS

- 5 Ps: preparation, planning, practice, pattern, performance.
- Three stages: pre, during, post-presentation.
- Five patterns: chronological, causal, problem–solution, spatial, topical.
- Four methods: manuscript, memorised, impromptu, extemporaneous.
- Manuscript reading limits eye contact.
- Memorised talks fail when a part is forgotten.

☐ I know the 5 Ps.
☐ I can name five patterns.
☐ I can name four methods.
☐ I know the limits of manuscript and memorised.
☐ I know how to handle impromptu.

Lecture 50: Oral Presentation: Planning & Preparation

Plan an oral presentation by fixing the purpose, selecting a familiar yet fresh topic (using an inventory and brainstorming), analysing the audience and researching. Draft audience-specific content in short, simple, spoken sentences with repetition, signposts and planned visual aids. Structure it into a brief attention-grabbing introduction, a body of two or three well-supported points and a conclusion that recapitulates and, if needed, calls for action. Anticipate questions, prepare notes and extra material, and then practise.

KEY FACTS

- Planning starts with purpose, topic and audience.
- Speak on a familiar topic and add new information.
- Maintain an inventory of topics.
- Write short sentences meant to be spoken.
- Repetition helps (Martin Luther King).
- Decide positions of visual aids in the outline.

☐ I can plan purpose, topic, audience.
☐ I know how to write for the ear.
☐ I know where to place visual aids.
☐ I can structure the three parts.
☐ I can anticipate questions.

Week 11: Presentations, Speeches and Interviews

Lecture 51: Making Effective Presentations

An effective presentation opens with a captivating hook, uses a clear voice at a moderate rate, appropriate volume and varied pitch, supportive body language and eye contact, humour and familiar examples, well-integrated aids and signposts, and an emphatic ending. Success depends on rehearsal: outline, timing, recording and feedback. Slides should be an outline, not a script. On the day, begin with a pause, stay natural, dress formally, handle questions gracefully and end with a summary. Freud reminds that the body speaks; Confucius that a superior man is modest in speech.

KEY FACTS

- Start with a question, story, anecdote or startling fact.
- Memorise opening and closing lines.
- Rate cited: 120–130 words per minute.
- Do not read slides.
- Time yourself and record your practice.
- Dress formally; check appearance.

☐ I can list features of an effective presentation.
☐ I know how to rehearse.
☐ I know delivery factors.
☐ I can use slides properly.
☐ I recall Freud and Confucius.

Lecture 52: Speeches for Various Occasions

Professionals must be ready to give speeches on occasions. Unlike presentations, speeches are emotional, subjective and without visual aids, so language, style, and especially the opening and closing matter, as illustrated by Antony's speech and a convocation ending. The six types are welcome, introductory, felicitation, commemorative, farewell and vote of thanks, each with its own tone and conventions: accurate facts, respect, no exaggeration, humility, brevity and warmth. Speak only sifted, valuable thoughts.

KEY FACTS

- Six speech types: welcome, introductory, felicitation, commemorative, farewell, vote of thanks.
- Speeches have no visual aids.
- Beginning generates intimacy; closing leaves a lasting impression.
- Welcome speech welcomes both guest and audience.
- Do not exaggerate in introductions or farewells.
- Commemorative speech uses a sorrowful tone.

☐ I can differentiate speech and presentation.
☐ I can list six types.

☐ I know each type's tone.
☐ I know how to open and close.
☐ I recall Longfellow and Buddha.

Lecture 53: Interviews

An interview is a systematic, mostly oral face-to-face method to test an interviewee's traits; it has many forms: informative, persuasive, exit, evaluation, counselling, conflict resolution, disciplinary, termination and job interviews. Success needs confidence from information, careful listening, anticipation of questions, formal language, awareness of strengths and weaknesses and understanding the interviewer's expectations. Recruitment proceeds through screening, tests, GD, negotiation, stress interview and medical test; recruiters seek attitude, adaptability, aptitude, team spirit and clarity. Preparation (Singleton) and getting started (Twain) matter most.

KEY FACTS

- Interview: face-to-face, mostly oral, systematic.
- Pauline V. Young's definition.
- Types include exit, evaluation, counselling, conflict resolution, disciplinary and termination.
- Develop confidence by gathering information.
- Listen fully before answering.
- Use formal language.

☐ I can define interview.
☐ I know the types.
☐ I know the stages of recruitment.
☐ I know recruiters' expectations.
☐ I recall Young, Singleton, Twain.

Lecture 54: Planning and Preparation: Part-1

Preparation for an interview begins long before the call. Analyse yourself honestly (qualifications, achievements, strengths, weaknesses, values, personality, background, hobbies, goals), identify and prioritise your skills to form a USP, and research both the organisation (website, growth, culture, new products) and the job (roles, responsibilities, prospects). Revise subject knowledge and update skills. Skills are intuitive (adaptability, assertiveness, creativity, resourcefulness) or learned (computer, marketing, speaking, time management, leadership, writing). Build an interview file and a saleable résumé, and keep the will to win.

KEY FACTS

- First preparatory step: analyse yourself.
- Second: identify your skills.
- Research the organisation and the job position.
- Revise subject knowledge.
- Skills are intuitive or learned.
- USP: unique selling product.

☐ I can list preparatory steps.
☐ I can do a self-analysis.
☐ I know intuitive versus learned skills.
☐ I know how to research an organisation and job.
☐ I know the contents of an interview file.

Lecture 55: Planning and Preparation: Part II

A résumé (French: summary) or CV (Latin: course of life) is a formatted, specific, error-free document that kindles interest and secures an interview call. It presents career objective, education, experience, activities, honours, skills (computer, foreign language, writing, problem solving, decision making) and attributes (enthusiasm, initiative, motivation, adaptability, humour). Formats are chronological (experienced), functional/skill (entry-level) and hybrid. Open with heading, a specific career objective and qualifications from highest downward; use action verbs, keep to 1–1.5 pages, give references only on request, and never mention salary, criticise employers or overestimate yourself.

KEY FACTS

- Résumé is French for summary; CV is Latin.
- Purpose: to get an interview call.
- No handwritten résumés today.
- Résumé must be specific, error-free, formatted.
- Use action verbs in the past tense.
- Three types: chronological, functional (skill), hybrid.

☐ I can differentiate résumé and CV.
☐ I know the three formats.
☐ I can write a heading and career objective.
☐ I can use action verbs.
☐ I know the do’s and don’ts.

Week 12: Resume, Interviews, Emotional Intelligence and Grammar

Lecture 56: Drafting an Effective Resume

An effective résumé opens with a specific one-to-three-line objective, lists education from latest to earliest with grades as on the marks sheet, names real additional courses, uses parallel action-verb phrases for experience, highlights activities, honours and named special skills, and gives professional references only when needed. The covering letter, a short three-paragraph business/sales letter, attracts the reader in the first paragraph, shows rather than tells in the body, and closes emphatically with a request for an interview. Language should be active, specific, unbiased and error free.

KEY FACTS

- Objective statement: 1 to 3 lines.
- A résumé is a passport; leave something for the interview.
- Education in reverse chronological order.
- Mention CGPA or percentage as on the marks sheet.
- Write the course name, not the code.
- Never mention what you do not have.

☐ I can write a specific objective.
☐ I can list education correctly.
☐ I can use action verbs and parallelism.
☐ I can structure a covering letter.
☐ I can avoid weak and biased language.

Lecture 57: Facing Job Interviews: Part- I

Facing an interview calls for preparation, patience, positivity and nerve control. Let the interviewer lead, listen fully, pause before answering and use tact. Appearance, personality, dress, grooming, voice and mannerisms all communicate; Carnegie stresses that personality (even a lovely smile) can outweigh degrees. Men should wear a well-tailored navy, brown or grey suit, button-down shirt, simple tie ending at the belt centre and polished black shoes; women a conservative business suit or full dress, low-heeled pumps and minimal jewellery. Speak clearly with controlled rate, use pauses, remain polite with tricky questions, and remember that every interview is a learning experience.

KEY FACTS

- Preparation is the best way to face an interview.
- Question types: open, closed, probing, reflective, loaded, hypothetical, leading.
- Let the interviewer lead; do not answer before the question ends.
- Half the battle is won by nonverbal behaviour.
- Carnegie’s smile example.
- Men: navy blue, dark brown or grey suit; black polished shoes.

☐ I can list types of questions.
☐ I know how to stay patient and positive.
☐ I know the dress code for men and women.
☐ I know voice and nonverbal tips.
☐ I recall the Carnegie example.

Lecture 58: Facing Job Interviews: Part II

Interviews use seven kinds of questions: open (comfort-building), closed (facts), probing (opinions), reflective (reasoning), loaded (embedded bias), hypothetical (crisis decisions) and leading (suggesting answers). Answers should be logical, honest, affirmative and justified: present weaknesses as merits, avoid disclosing salary or criticising employers, remain modest about the future, show team spirit and

ethics, and handle personal questions calmly. Before the interview prepare dress, documents and current awareness; on the day arrive early, talk to other candidates, enter confidently, sit when asked, maintain eye contact and leave gracefully, closing the door gently.

KEY FACTS

- Seven types: open, closed, probing, reflective, loaded, hypothetical, leading.
- First question is usually ‘Tell us briefly about yourself’.
- Closed questions are often followed by justification questions.
- Hypothetical questions test decision making in crises.
- Do not disclose salary; do not criticise past employers.
- Present weakness as a merit.

☐ I can name and exemplify seven question types.
☐ I can answer weakness and salary questions.
☐ I can handle personal questions.
☐ I know before/during/after tips.
☐ I recall the Dickens quote.

Lecture 59: Emotional Intelligence and Critical Thinking

Emotional intelligence is the capacity to recognise, motivate and manage emotions in oneself and others; it complements IQ, with IQ helping one get a job and EQ helping one succeed and lead. Its personal competencies are self-awareness (emotional awareness, self-assessment, self-confidence), self-regulation (self-control, trustworthiness, conscientiousness, adaptability, innovation) and motivation (achievement drive, initiative, commitment, optimism); its social competencies are empathy (understanding and developing others, service orientation, diversity and political awareness) and social skills (influence, communication, conflict management, leadership, change catalysing, bonds, collaboration, teamwork). Critical thinking adds imagination, relevant questioning, non-judgmental observation, learning and unlearning, awareness of relationships and neutrality. Respect differences: be different, not indifferent.

KEY FACTS

- EI popularised by Goleman’s *Working with Emotional Intelligence*.
- IQ gets the job; EQ ensures success.
- Five EI components: self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, social skills.
- Self-analysis is the first step in EI.
- Critical thinking improves thinking quality by imposing intellectual standards.
- Do not be judgmental; ask relevant questions.

☐ I can define EI and critical thinking.
☐ I can list the five EI components.
☐ I can contrast IQ and EQ.
☐ I can list critical-thinking components.
☐ I recall Frost and Shakespeare quotes.

Lecture 60: Applied Grammar

Applied grammar focuses on common trouble spots: always-plural nouns (police, clothes, scissors, trousers), singular nouns ending in s (news, politics, mathematics, diabetes), capitalisation rules for titles, designations and department names, apostrophes for possession (never in yours), subject–verb agreement (none of, either/or, neither/nor, each of, indefinite pronouns, a great deal of), articles chosen by sound, question tags (including 'aren't I?'), prepositions (senior to, since/for, beside/besides, between), voice and transformation, and confusing words (affect/effect, loose/lose, stationary/stationery, later/latter, compliment/complement, desert/dessert, elicit/illicit). The course closes with a message that balanced emotion and intellect, careful communication and constant learning lead to success.

KEY FACTS

- Police, clothes, scissors, trousers are plural.
- News, politics, mathematics, diabetes are singular.
- Children is already plural.
- Never write your's or yours'.
- James' or James's both acceptable.
- Either/or: singular verb for singular subjects; nearest-subject rule otherwise.

☐ I know always-plural and singular-s nouns.
☐ I can capitalise titles correctly.
☐ I can use apostrophes properly.
☐ I can apply agreement rules.
☐ I can choose articles, tags, prepositions.
☐ I can avoid confusing word pairs.